

Table of Contents

- Introduction
- 1. Inconsistent Website Architecture
- 2. Dynamic Navigation – Zero Real HTML Links
- 3. Broken, Inconsistent & Unstable APIs
- 4. Extremely Noisy HTML
- 5. Content Not Available Without JavaScript
- 6. Redirect Hell
- 7. Lack of Canonical URL Structure
- 8. Duplicate Pages Everywhere
- 9. File Attachments Without Metadata
- 10. Every College Uses Its Own System
- 11. Chaotic Content IDs
- 12. Hidden Content in JavaScript
- 13. Heavy Headers Loaded 2–3 Times
- 14. Broken Multilingual System
- Final Conclusion

Introduction

During the development of the AAST Knowledge Graph & RAG System, extensive crawling and scraping were performed on the official AAST website. We discovered major structural, architectural, and API-related issues that significantly complicate automated data extraction.

1. Inconsistent Website Architecture

The AAST website is not a unified system. It contains over seven unrelated subsystems including contenttemp.php, programtemp.php, cv.php, presidency templates, React/Vue pages, legacy Joomla pages, and static templates.

2. Dynamic Navigation – Zero Real HTML Links

Navigation links only appear after JavaScript execution or user interaction. Static crawlers cannot discover pages from homepage.

3. Broken, Inconsistent & Unstable APIs

APIs return inconsistent structures, null outputs, random redirects, and missing fields.

4. Extremely Noisy HTML

Pages include excessive JS, repeated headers, analytics scripts, and redundant structures.

5. Content Not Available Without JavaScript

Almost all AAST content loads dynamically through AJAX, making static scraping ineffective.

6. Redirect Hell

URLs redirect unpredictably, including loops and forced homepage redirects.

7. Lack of Canonical URL Structure

program_id, unit_id, and page_id formats change arbitrarily across templates.

8. Duplicate Pages Everywhere

Pages appear in English, Arabic, print, legacy, backup, and template formats.

9. File Attachments Without Metadata

PDFs lack names, timestamps, and categories.

10. Every College Uses Its Own System

Different colleges rely on different CMS structures and layouts.

11. Chaotic Content IDs

IDs have no pattern (e.g., 65500031, 234, 000000544). Requires brute-force discovery.

12. Hidden Content in JavaScript

Roadmaps, publications, grading systems load through AJAX endpoints.

13. Heavy Headers Loaded 2–3 Times

Duplicate menus and scripts inflate DOM.

14. Broken Multilingual System

Language switching uses redirect scripts causing duplicates.

Final Conclusion

The AAST website is not scrape-friendly: inconsistent, JS-dependent, API■unstable, and lacks a unified structure.